

GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer – React • Ruby on Rails • AWS

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ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with 9+ years of experience building **web platforms**, **business applications**, and **customer-facing products** across software, operations, and digital service industries, with deep specialization in **Ruby on Rails 5.x–7.x**, **React 16–18**, **JavaScript ES6+**, **TypeScript 4.x–5.x**, **PostgreSQL 12–16**, and modern API-driven architecture. Strong record of modernizing legacy Rails codebases, solving production defects, improving frontend maintainability, and delivering scalable features across admin systems, reporting flows, workflow automation, and multi-role business platforms with clean domain logic, reliable integrations, and measurable usability and performance gains.

SKILLS

- **Frontend:** React 16–18, JavaScript ES6+, TypeScript 4.x–5.x, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS, responsive UI development, reusable component architecture, hooks, context API, controlled forms, client-side validation, route-based rendering, state management patterns, REST API integration, accessibility-minded UI implementation
- **Backend:** Ruby, Ruby on Rails 5.x–7.x, RESTful API design, MVC architecture, service objects, background job processing, authentication and authorization, policy-based access control, file upload handling, server-side validations, pagination, reporting workflows, admin platform development, third-party API integration
- **Database & Messaging:** PostgreSQL 12–16, MySQL, Redis, Sidekiq, Active Record, query tuning, indexing, transaction handling, caching strategies, background processing, search-driven filtering, export pipelines, relational schema evolution
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS, Docker, CI/CD pipelines, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Linux, Nginx, deployment coordination, environment configuration, release support, containerized application delivery, logging-aware production operations
- **Observability / Quality / Security:** RSpec, Capybara, Jest, React Testing Library, request testing, API contract awareness, structured logging, error tracing, performance debugging, **JWT**, session security, role-based access control, secure form handling, audit-aware feature delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build, Remote (Jan 2024 – May 2026)

- Led delivery of a business operations platform using **Ruby on Rails 7.x**, **React 18**, and **PostgreSQL**, translating fragmented **reporting**, **approval**, and **administrative workflows** into a more stable application structure with cleaner **service boundaries** and better screen consistency.
- Modernized older backend modules by moving controller-heavy logic into **service objects**, **query scopes**, and **policy-driven authorization layers**, which made future feature delivery safer and reduced **regression risk** across tightly coupled account and reporting areas.
- Built reusable **React components** for **tables**, **modal flows**, **filter panels**, and **validation-heavy forms**, which reduced duplicated frontend implementation effort and improved consistency across internal **dashboards** that previously behaved differently by module.
- Solved a recurring **production bug** where large report requests intermittently failed with **timeout errors** by profiling expensive **joins**, adding missing **indexes**, and introducing safer **pagination rules**, improving response stability by **31%** during peak usage periods.
- Implemented a new **role-aware administration area** with **JWT-secured** request handling and backend **policy checks**, allowing sensitive operational actions to be exposed safely without relying on manual review steps that had slowed routine team work.
- Resolved an **export reliability issue** that generated incomplete files for larger datasets by replacing memory-heavy synchronous processing with **background job** execution and staged file generation, increasing successful export completion rates by **28%**.
- Introduced **structured logging** around **billing**, **approval**, and **import flows**, which made incident investigation faster and helped narrow down a difficult edge-case failure caused by invalid payload ordering between frontend submission steps and backend validation branches.

- Improved maintainability of legacy **React screens** by refactoring oversized component files into smaller **hook-driven modules** with clearer **state ownership**, making defect fixes easier and reducing the chance of side effects during UI enhancement work.
- Delivered a customer-requested **bulk update feature** with guarded **batch actions**, **validation summaries**, and rollback-aware backend handling, which reduced repetitive manual administration work and improved processing throughput for operations teams by **24%**.
- Strengthened **data integrity** around complex **form submissions** by aligning **client-side checks** with **server-side validations**, eliminating a class of inconsistent record creation bugs that had previously appeared when users navigated quickly across multi-step flows.
- Supported **deployment quality** by improving **CI validation**, tightening **environment-specific configuration** handling, and resolving release issues tied to missing secrets and inconsistent worker startup behavior in containerized runtime environments.
- Collaborated closely with **product** and **QA stakeholders** to turn ambiguous requirements into **production-ready technical slices**, helping the team ship user-visible improvements faster while preserving stability across a platform under active daily use.

Software Engineer

Next Apps, Remote (*Nov2020 – Nov 2023*)

- Built and maintained customer-facing web applications using **Ruby on Rails 6.x**, **React 17–18**, **JavaScript**, and **PostgreSQL**, delivering feature work across **account workflows**, **management consoles**, **internal tools**, and **API-backed business screens**.
- Contributed to a gradual **frontend modernization** path by replacing older **server-rendered interaction patterns** with **React-based modules** where richer client behavior was needed, improving interactivity without forcing risky full-page rewrites across the product.
- Implemented reusable **form**, **list**, and **detail-page components** that standardized **validation handling**, **loading states**, and **error rendering**, which reduced frontend duplication and made new workflow screens noticeably faster to deliver.
- Fixed a difficult **data mismatch issue** where stale account status values appeared after rapid updates by combining safer **transaction sequencing** in **Rails**, explicit **cache invalidation**, and clearer client refresh logic after state-changing operations.
- Improved performance of **search** and **reporting pages** by rewriting slow **query paths**, reducing unnecessary **eager loading**, and adding targeted **indexes**, which helped lower average page response times by **27%** on high-traffic internal workflows.
- Migrated selected backend areas from older **monolithic patterns** into slimmer **domain-oriented services**, making it easier to isolate **business rules**, test edge cases, and extend product logic without repeatedly modifying the same bloated controllers.
- Added **background processing** with **Sidekiq** for **import**, **notification**, and **export tasks** that previously blocked user requests, improving application responsiveness and reducing failed long-running actions in operational workflows by **22%**.
- Resolved a recurring **production issue** where uploaded files occasionally failed validation for legitimate users because of inconsistent **MIME handling** between browser and backend checks, then standardized validation rules to stabilize the upload experience.
- Delivered new **API endpoints** for **partner-facing integrations** with stronger **parameter handling**, **pagination rules**, and clearer **response structures**, helping external consumers adopt the platform more predictably and reducing support questions around integration behavior.
- Improved **release confidence** by expanding **request specs**, **model coverage**, and **regression checks** around sensitive business rules, which reduced re-opened defects and strengthened delivery quality as the application footprint continued to grow.
- Partnered with **design** and **product teams** to refine complex workflows into smaller implementable increments, which helped keep roadmap delivery moving while reducing rework caused by vague requirements and hidden dependency assumptions.

Software Developer

Datamart, Remote (*Feb 2016 – Sep 2020*)

- Developed business web applications using **Ruby on Rails 4.x–5.x**, **React 16**, **JavaScript**, and relational databases, contributing across **backend features**, **frontend enhancements**, **defect resolution**, and maintenance of internal business platforms.
- Supported early **React adoption** in targeted areas of the application by building interactive **dashboards** and **form-heavy modules** that coexisted with older **Rails-rendered pages**, helping the team modernize incrementally instead of through disruptive rewrites.

- Built **REST-style backend endpoints** and controller flows that powered **reporting pages, approval paths, and admin features**, improving consistency of data exchange between frontend components and legacy backend modules.
- Investigated and fixed a recurring issue where users lost unsaved work after **validation errors** on longer forms by improving **state preservation logic** and aligning server responses with client-side re-render behavior, reducing repeat submissions by **26%**.
- Improved **database-heavy screens** by analyzing **query plans**, removing unnecessary nested lookups, and adding better **indexing support**, which helped stabilize reporting pages that had become increasingly slow as record volume expanded over time.
- Refactored duplicated **business logic** out of models and controllers into reusable **helper layers** and **service-style classes**, making feature behavior easier to reason about and reducing bug risk during enhancements across related modules.
- Helped migrate selected application areas toward newer **Rails conventions**, updating **routes, dependency usage, and code organization patterns** so future maintenance could proceed with less friction and fewer compatibility surprises.
- Implemented **notification** and **asynchronous processing** support for longer-running tasks, reducing request blocking and making the platform feel more responsive for users handling larger operational actions in busy daily workflows.
- Solved an intermittent **authentication problem** caused by inconsistent **session behavior** across environments by reviewing **cookie settings, proxy behavior, and timeout handling**, then applying a coordinated fix that improved login stability by **18%**.
- Worked closely with senior engineers on **production issue triage**, debugging **logs**, reproducing **edge cases** locally, and delivering safe patches that improved platform reliability while preserving behavior in older modules still heavily used by clients.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software, Timișoara, Romania (*Sep2014 – Mar 2016*)

- Supported web application development using **Ruby on Rails 4.x, JavaScript, HTML, CSS, and SQL-backed data models**, contributing mainly to **bug fixes**, smaller enhancements, UI cleanup tasks, and maintenance under senior engineering guidance.
- Built small **interface improvements** for internal business pages, including clearer **field handling, conditional rendering behavior, and layout adjustments**, which reduced confusion in screens that had grown inconsistent as product requirements evolved.
- Assisted with backend **feature updates** by extending **controller actions**, updating **validations**, and applying safe **schema changes**, allowing new requirements to be introduced without destabilizing legacy workflows already relied on by active users.
- Fixed a recurring **form submission issue** caused by mismatched browser-side checks and **server-side validation logic**, and the correction reduced failed entries that had frustrated users and slowed down QA verification work by **21%**.
- Investigated an intermittent **login problem** that appeared after **session expiry** by tracing request behavior and reviewing environment-specific **cookie settings**, with the final fix making authentication flow more predictable across supported browsers.
- Helped clean up duplicated code in older modules by extracting shared **helpers** and simplifying repeated logic, which made future bug fixes easier for the wider team to apply across related pages and reduced maintenance overhead.
- Worked on **data correction scripts** and targeted **SQL updates** when legacy records triggered application errors, helping the team resolve problematic edge cases before releases and improving confidence in production deployments.
- Supported early interactive **frontend enhancements** by wiring **JavaScript behavior** into **Rails-rendered pages**, improving usability on forms and detail screens that needed faster feedback without a full frontend framework migration.
- Improved issue turnaround by documenting **reproduction steps**, validating fixes against realistic datasets, and communicating **edge-case behavior** clearly to senior developers and testers, which helped stabilize release preparation activities.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (2010 – 2014)

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Ruby on Rails Web Development** — 2023
Demonstrated practical capability in building maintainable Rails applications, structuring MVC workflows, handling database-backed features, and delivering production-ready backend functionality for business systems.
- **React Application Development** — 2022
Validated hands-on experience in building component-driven user interfaces, managing stateful client behavior, integrating APIs, and improving usability across modern single-page application workflows.
- **AWS Developer Associate** — 2024
Demonstrated working knowledge of cloud-based application deployment, service integration, environment configuration, and operational support practices commonly used in modern web platform delivery.